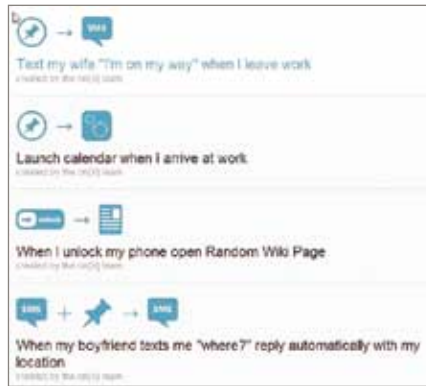


your system ROM every night to your SD card and have it sync to Dropbox/Google Drive/Box/SugarSync using FolderSync. (<http://dgit.in/MqPhZu>)

For a much larger and comprehensive list of all that Tasker is capable of, visit <http://dgit.in/Mh4g74>

These tasks barely scratch the surface of what Tasker is capable of – use your imagination to come up with some creative ways to put your phone to work! Having said that, Tasker isn't the only app that can automate your phone. There are free alternatives like Automate It! (<http://dgit.in/PjglJT>) and Llama (<http://dgit.in/LyRYX0>) for Android that can perform a subset of Tasker's features. Most common triggers like time, location or the phone's state can be used to create rules with these apps, though they're not quite as flexible as Tasker. A new entrant is an app by (none other than) Microsoft called On{x} which is strangely available only on Android devices and not Windows Phones. After signing up, On{x} uses Javascript APIs to create automation 'recipes' such as reminding you to buy milk on the way back from work, automatically sending out an SMS when you leave for



Microsoft's On{x} simplifies tasks

home or opening your calendar app when you reach work. Though creating a recipe is slightly complex, there's a large collection of ready-to-use recipes that you can try out. Here's how you can use On{x} to automate tasks on your Android device:

1. Download the On{x} Android app from the Google Play Store. <http://dgit.in/NleGQZ>
2. Sign in to the app using your Facebook credentials. (The app is currently in beta and only supports login via Facebook.)
3. Head over to the On{x} website at <http://dgit.in/LI85Sc> and sign in once again.

4. You'll see a list of recipes that you can send to your phone. Simply clicking on 'add' should push them to your phone, and they'll start getting implemented right away.
5. Any text that is highlighted in the recipe, can be customized. For e.g. you can specify your home or office location by specifying their latitude and longitude on Bing maps. For tasks that require a phone number, you'll obviously have to enter it for the task to work.

Near Field Communications is a new concept that draws on existing RFID technology to create 'tags' that support 2-way communication. Apps like NFC Task Launcher allow you to automate actions by simply tapping your phone against an NFC tag. Say you're heading out to work, you can tap your NFC enabled phone on an NFC tag placed on the back of your main door and perform an action like turning on the WiFi or turning up the ringer volume all the way. Though only a few devices support NFC at the moment, we love the idea of tapping your phone and having it perform a bunch of tasks right away!



Take some time out, and find out what you can do to let the web take care of itself

As the web becomes more and more social, users find themselves having multiple online accounts on social networks, cloud storage services, book-marking services and so on. Instead of managing the nitty-gritties of sharing data between accounts, why not automate

the whole process? From saving email attachments to your computer, posting your favourite YouTube link on Facebook, to getting weather alerts on your mobile, the internet's got your back. What's better is this process of automation does not require you to have any programming knowledge whatsoever, as all services provide an easy interface to create and store such automation rules. Probably the most well-known and widely-used service is If This-Then That, better known as www.ifttt.com. Ifttt provides a simple way to set up tasks based on a given scenario. You

give it a condition ('if this') and then it does the job ('that') for you. The condition is called a trigger, and the job is called an action. The trigger and action are based on various web based tools called channels, which include all major online services like Facebook, Twitter, Gmail, Dropbox, Google Reader, Pocket, Evernote, Instapaper and Instagram. Put one channel's trigger together with another channel's action, and you have with yourselves a task. A task is an automation rule that you define. To create a task involving an online account, you need to activate the channel first, by signing in to the respective network. Most channels like Twitter, Facebook and Dropbox use OAuth, so the authentication process is very secure. Once you've got your channels activated, it's time to set up a task. On logging in, you'll see your dashboard with a list of all